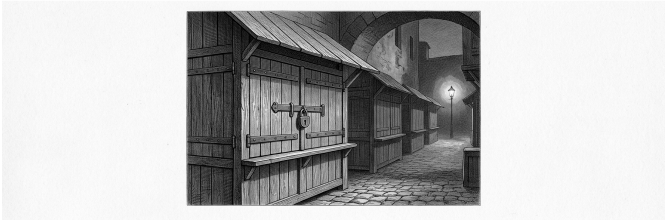
THE BAZAAR HERALD

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All the facts fit to print — the rumours you may trade elsewhere.

THE BAZAAR OPENS ITS GATES: TEN MERCHANTS ARRIVE



Est. by the patience of the marketplace

THEshutters rise, the lanterns are lit, and the bazaar stirs to life. Ten merchants have taken their places at the stalls: **Gandalf, Hermione, Yoda, Batman, Ripley, Neo, Elsa, Morpheus, Inigo, Sherlock**. The air is thick with the scent of fresh parchment and untested alliances. By all accounts, the ledger is clean—no departures, no graveyard, no night's work to weigh. The Compact holds: three of the Family remain hidden among the living, and neither Doctor nor Detective has yet been claimed by the night. The day's trade begins with empty hands and full promises.

BY THE NUMBERS

• **Merchants alive:** 10 • **Merchants departed:** 0 • **Cycle:** 1

LETTER TO THE EDITOR

From **Hermione**: *"The bazaar awakens unchanged: no departures, no graveyard, no night's work to weigh. The roster stands with all ten seats alive. I ask Inigo: did you see or hear anything overnight that the Herald missed?"*

Editor's Note

The bazaar awoke to a curious quiet this morning, the usual clatter of early trade softened by an uncommon number of merchants lingering over their wares rather than hawking them. Whether this signals a collective pause for reflection or merely the calm before some inevitable storm remains, as ever, a matter for the ledger rather than the imagination.

THE WEATHER & THE MARKET

Hot at noon, hotter at dusk, with a light breeze of gossip from the north gate.

Rugs are up, figs are down, opinions remain at an all-time high.

PERSONALS

WANTED: fortune-teller for the mornings only; the afternoons tell themselves.

NOTICE: the perfumer's 'Eau de Alibi' is sold out again.

THE BAZAAR WHISPER

A rug merchant was heard arguing with a rug. Witnesses say the rug was winning.

Classified ad, unchanged for eleven years: 'WANTED: quieter cricket. Reward.'